BreakfastWise MRD

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1. Problem statement and scope

Hotels with an included breakfast buffet must cook before guests arrive, so they guess quantities and end up with either wasted food or empty trays. BreakfastWise turns occupancy and past breakfast records into a guest forecast and suggested quantities for key dishes.

Problem statement (AI FORGE 2K26): Hotels often struggle to predict breakfast demand, leading to food wastage or shortages. Build a breakfast-demand forecasting dashboard using occupancy and previous consumption data.

5-line scope note

#	Line	Our answer
1	User	Head chef of an independent 100-room business hotel, planning tomorrow's breakfast at about 9 PM
2	Problem	Prep quantities are guessed, which causes waste or shortages
3	Main flow	Enter tomorrow's expected guests, see predicted breakfast guests and suggested quantities for 5 dishes, review recent waste and stock-outs
4	Data	60 days of clearly labelled synthetic history: expected guests, breakfast guests, and prepared, consumed, discarded and stock-out per dish
5	Out of scope	Live hotel-system (PMS) integration, machine-learning models, inventory ordering, multiple properties

2. Target segment and persona

Segment: Independent business hotels with about 50–150 rooms in tier-2 Tamil Nadu cities such as Trichy and Madurai, offering a breakfast buffet included in the room rate. *(ASSUMPTION: room range, location and need not yet validated through hotel interviews.)*

Why this segment: A buffet must be cooked before anyone eats, so the hotel carries the full forecasting risk. Independent hotels usually lack the central F&B systems and procurement teams that chains have, so the decision rests on one chef's judgment. *(ASSUMPTION)*

Persona: Chef Murugan

Field	Detail
Role	Head chef, independent 100-room business hotel
When he plans	About 9 PM, for the next morning's breakfast
Goal	Prepare enough of each dish so no guest misses out, without throwing food away
Pain point 1	Over-preparing on quiet days wastes food and money
Pain point 2	Under-preparing on busy days leaves popular dishes empty and guests unhappy
Current workaround	Estimates from experience, yesterday's attendance and expected occupancy

Secondary user: The F&B manager, who later reviews forecast versus actual results.

The persona's workflow is our initial assumption and needs validation with a real chef or hotel manager.

3. Market need

Need statement: Chef Murugan, head chef of a 100-room business hotel, needs to know each evening how many guests will eat breakfast and how much of each dish to prepare, because over-preparing wastes food and under-preparing leaves guests without breakfast; today he estimates from experience, which fails when attendance shifts between weekdays and weekends or occupancy changes sharply.

Reasoning that supports the need

- A buffet included in the room rate is cooked in advance, so quantity must be decided before demand is known.
- Not every staying guest eats breakfast, and the share who do can differ by day of the week. Occupancy alone does not give the answer. *(ASSUMPTION)*
- If a dish runs out, recorded consumption understates real demand, so guessing from past leftovers alone repeats the shortage.

- Hotels already know tomorrow's expected guests, so the main input is available the evening before. *(ASSUMPTION)*

Evidence status: No hotel interviews completed yet. Planned: speak to at least one hotel chef, or a college mess cook as a proxy (not our segment), using the tests in section 6.

4. Alternatives today and the gap

None of today's methods turns past records into a consistent, checkable forecast for tomorrow. How kitchens work today is our assumption until confirmed with a chef.

Alternative	How it works today (ASSUMPTION)	Gap BreakfastWise fills
Chef's experience and gut feel	The chef estimates from experience, yesterday's attendance and expected occupancy	Estimates vary between staff and days; BreakfastWise gives a consistent forecast anyone can check by hand
Fixed preparation rule	The kitchen prepares for a fixed share of expected guests	A fixed share ignores weekday patterns; BreakfastWise uses the attendance rate from the same weekday over the last 4 weeks
Paper register or WhatsApp notes	Staff record guest counts, food prepared or leftovers by hand	Records alone don't calculate anything; BreakfastWise turns them into suggested quantities and a waste and stock-out history

Not listed: Hotel PMS reports. They may show occupancy but we have not verified which systems our target hotels use or what they report; to be checked during validation.

5. Opportunity and why now

BreakfastWise can turn records hotels may already keep into a simple guest forecast and suggested dish quantities, without an expensive hotel management system.

Independent business hotels in Trichy and Madurai prepare breakfast before knowing how many guests will attend. Rising food costs make over-preparation expensive *(ASSUMPTION: not yet sourced)*, while under-preparation leads to shortages and unhappy guests.

Now is a practical time because digital occupancy records and simple web apps make a lightweight forecasting tool feasible on a kitchen phone or laptop. Whether suitable records exist, how much food is wasted, and whether chefs will use such a tool must be validated with real hotels before we claim any measurable benefit.

6. Three weakest assumptions

Our least certain assumption is A1: that hotels keep the food records BreakfastWise needs. If it fails, the guest forecast still works from occupancy and breakfast counts alone, and dish suggestions improve once the chef logs a few weeks of data.

#	Assumption	Why it is weak	Quick test
A1	Independent business hotels record breakfast guest counts and quantities prepared, consumed and discarded	Without these records, dish-level consumption and waste cannot be calculated; staff may lack time to record during service	Visit one hotel (or a college mess as a proxy) and ask the chef to show how they record food prepared, eaten and thrown away
A2	Past occupancy and attendance patterns predict tomorrow's breakfast guests well enough	Group bookings, holidays and events can shift attendance away from historical averages	Get 7 days of expected guests and actual breakfast counts from one hotel; forecast each day and compare with actual
A3	Chefs will trust and use the suggested quantities	Experienced chefs may prefer their own judgment, especially if a suggestion looks unrealistic	Show a working mock-up to one chef, ask them to plan tomorrow's breakfast with it, and note what they change and why